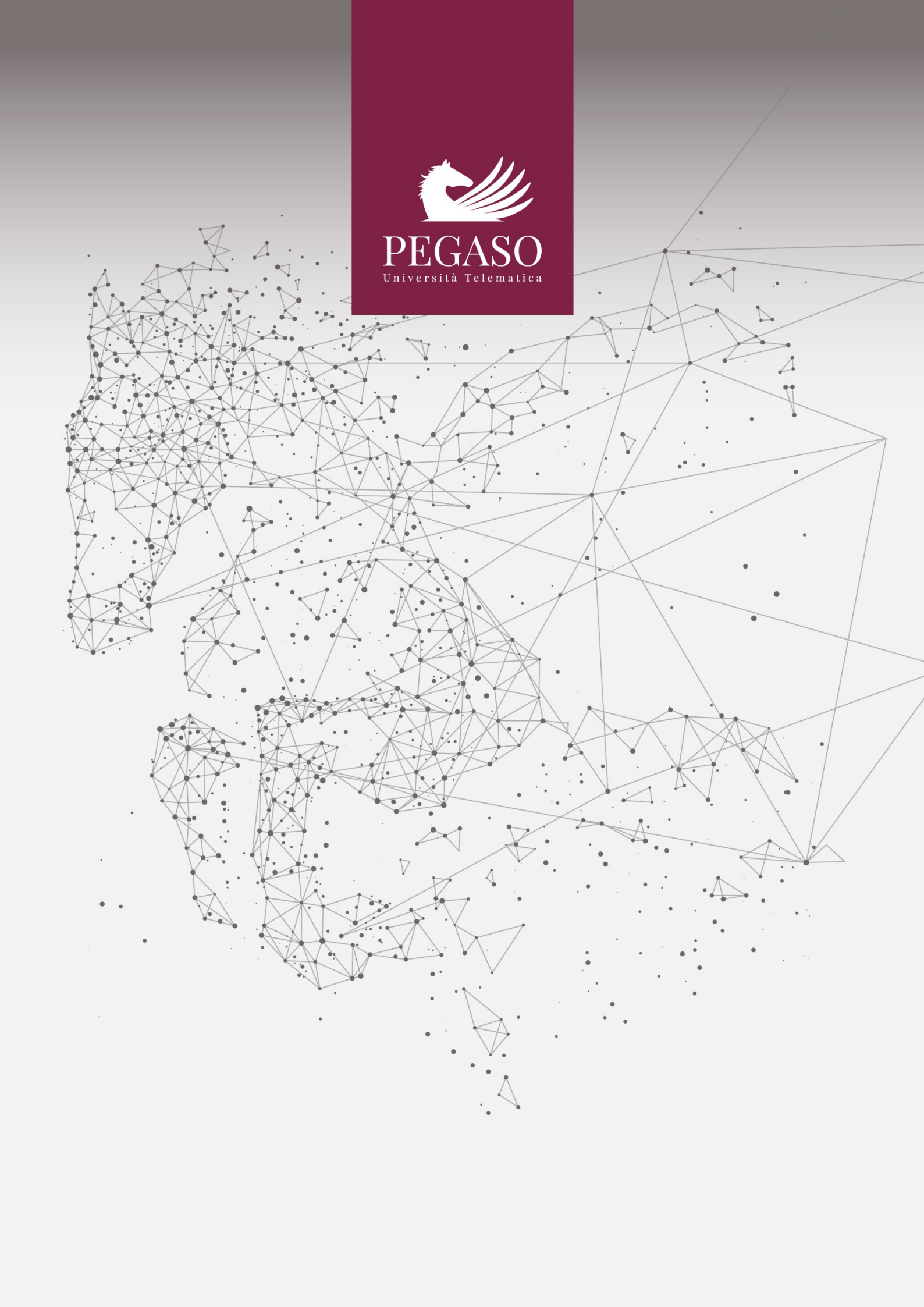

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1. Articles

Below are the rules for a/an, the, or no article:

We normally use A/AN when we talk about something which isn't specific or it's the first time we mention something. When we talk about something specific or talk about it again, we use THE.

We also use THE when something is unique (there is only one), with superlatives or with the names of some places (e.g. oceans, deserts, mountain ranges).

We use NO ARTICLE when we talk about

people or things in general, and with the names of most places (e.g. continents, countries, cities, lakes).

Articles (a/an, the or no article)

We use a /an:

- to talk about something that isn't specific.

  Have you got a pen? (a particular pen)
- the first time we mention something.

  I saw a beautiful painting in the museum.

We use “the”:

- the second time we mention something.

  A man and a woman were waiting for us at the airport.

  The man helped us with our suitcases.
- when something is unique.

  The sun looked really beautiful from the top of the mountain.
- with superlatives.

  It was the best holiday of my life.
- with the names of some places, such as oceans (e.g. the Atlantic Ocean), deserts (e.g. the Sahara Desert) and mountain ranges (e.g. the Himalayas).

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We use no article:

- to talk about plural or uncountable nouns in general.

  I never stay in (-) hotels because they're so expensive.

  (-) Tourism brings a lot of money to the area.

- the names of most places, for example the names of continents, countries, cities and lakes.

  Read the sentences and look at the words in bold.

  In 1978 the Chinese started planting **a wall** of trees. Now **the wall** has 66 billion trees.

  It's **the largest** hot desert in the world.

  The Gobi Desert is getting larger.

  Countries in **Africa** plan to build a wall.

  People know about **the Great Wall of China**.[1]

[1] J. Hughes, H. Stephenson and P. Dummett, *Life Pre-Intermediate Student's Book*, Hampshire, National Geographic Learning, 2019 (61, 164)

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2. Defining Relative Clauses

Relative clauses and pronouns

1 Relative pronouns

The most common relative pronouns are:

who (= subject) and whom (= object) to refer to people

which to refer to things

that to refer to either people or things

whose the possessive of who and which

when used after nouns referring to time

where used after nouns referring to place

why used to refer to reasons

Note: the relative pronoun replaces the subject or the object.

People who (they) live in glass houses shouldn't throw stones.

The vase, which I bought (it) years ago, is very valuable.

Note: what is not a relative pronoun.

2 Defining relative clauses

In defining relative clauses - the relative clause defines or identifies the person, thing, time, place or reason.

Chris is the son of a woman who works in television.

That's the man whose son is an actor.

Winter was the time when people tended to get insufficient fresh food.

I know the place where the play is set.

I can't imagine why he would want to leave you.

In this kind of relative clause **that** can be used instead of **who** or **which**.

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The girl that (who) lives next door rides a motorbike.

The sports center that (which) is opening soon will offer great new facilities.

- The relative pronoun can be left out if it is the object of the verb in the relative clause.

The person (who/that) I spoke to yesterday said it was free.

Sue bought the watch (which/that) shed seen.

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3. Non-Defining Relative Clauses

Relative clauses give extra information which CAN be omitted.

Commas are used before and after the relative clause.

The pronoun **that** CANNOT be used instead of **who** or **which**.

The museum, where you can see Roman pottery, is free.

The witness, who refused to be named, said the police had acted unwisely.

- Prepositions in relative clauses

Prepositions can come before the relative pronoun or at the end of the relative clause, depending on whether the sentence is formal or informal.

The person to whom I spoke told me the hotel was fully booked. (formal)

John, who I bought my car from, has gone abroad.[2] (informal)

Study Wikipedia's definition of an economic system (all articles and relative pronouns have been underlined in order to understand the application of the relevant rules):

An economic system is a type of social systems. The mode of production is a related concept. All economic systems must confront and solve the four fundamental economic problems:

- What kinds and quantities of goods shall be produced: This fundamental economic problem is anchored on the theory of pricing. The theory of pricing, in this context, has to do with the economic decision-making between the production of capital goods and consumer goods in the economy in the face of scarce resources. In this regard, the critical evaluation of the needs of the society based on population distribution in terms of age, sex, occupation, and geography is very pertinent.
- How goods shall be produced: The fundamental problem of how goods shall be produced is largely hinged on the least-cost method of production to be adopted as gainfully peculiar to the economically decided goods and services to be produced. On a broad note, the possible production method includes labor-intensive and capital-intensive methods.

[2] J. Bell and A. Thomas, *Gold First Coursebook New Edition*, Essex, Pearson Education Limited, 2014 (172-173)

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- How the output will be distributed: Production is said to be completed when the goods get to the final consumers. This fundamental problem of how the output will be distributed seeks to identify the best possible medium through which bottlenecks and the clogs in the wheel of the chain of economic resources distributions can reduce to the barest minimum and optimize consumers' satisfaction.
- When to produce: Consumer satisfaction is partly a function of seasonal analysis as the forces of demand and supply have a lot to do with time. This fundamental economic problem requires an intensive study of time dynamics and seasonal variation vis-a-vis the satisfaction of consumers' needs.

Exercises

Make one sentence from two. Use who / that / which

1. girl was injured in the accident. She is now in hospital.

ex. The girl who was injured in the accident is now in hospital.

2. A waitress served us. She was impolite and impatient.

_____

3. A building was destroyed in the fire. It has now been rebuilt.

The _____

4. Some people were arrested. They have now been released.

The _____

5. A bus goes to the airport. It runs every half hour.

The _____.

Are these sentences right or wrong? Correct them where necessary.

6. I don't like stories who have unhappy endings.

ex. correction = stories that have

7. What was the name of the person who phoned you?

ex. OK

8. Where's the nearest shop who sells newspapers?

9. The driver which caused the accident was fined £500.

10. Do you know the person that took these photographs?

11. We live in a world what is changing all the time.

12. Dan said some things about me that were not true.

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13. What was the name of the horse it won the race?[3]

Correct the sentences that are wrong and put in commas where necessary. If the sentence is correct, write "OK".

14. Colin told me about his new job that he's enjoying very much.

ex. Colin told me about his new job, which he's enjoying very much.

15. My office that is on the second floor is very small.

16. The office I'm using at the moment is very small.

17. Ben's father that used to be a teacher now works for a TV company.

18. The doctor that examined me couldn't find anything wrong.

19. The sun that is one of millions of stars in the universe provides us with heat and light.[4]

Choose the correct option (**-** indicates that no article is needed).

20. Redwood trees are ***the / -*** tallest trees in the world.

21. ***- / The*** Lake Superior is the largest lake in the USA.

22. China built ***the / an*** amazing bridge over the Dehang Canyon. ***The / A*** bridge is the highest in the world.

23. Mercury is the closest planet ***to - / the*** Sun.

24. ***- / The*** honey bees only live for five to six weeks.

25. Until around 4,000 years ago, ***the / -*** Sahara Desert was green and animals probably lived there.

26. In ***a / the*** small town called Rjukan in ***the / -*** Norway, there is no sunlight for six months a year. People in ***the / -*** Rjukan live without ***the / a*** sun from September to March. But this is changing thanks to Martin Andersen ***- / a*** local man who had the clever idea to use ***a / the*** mirror to bring sunlight to the town. The ***- / a*** mirror is on top of a mountain next to the town and it reflects light from the sun onto ***a / the*** town's main square. ***The / -*** people love coming to the main square.[5]

Translate the following text:

27. In the spring and summer, there is often a water shortage in the Himalayan mountains. So during the winter people make ice towers. They put one end of a long pipe into a river high in the mountains, and then they take the other end of the pipe down to the village. The water comes out of the pipe and freezes in a fountain to make an iced tower in the village, then it melts and the farmers can use it on their land. The Atacama Desert in Chile is one of the driest parts of the world. There is very little rain, but there is fog, and

[3] R. Murphy, *English Grammar in Use Third Edition*, Cambridge, Cambridge University Press, 2004 (185)
[4] R. Murphy, *English Grammar in Use Third Edition*, Cambridge, Cambridge University Press, 2004 (191)
[5] . Hughes, H. Stephenson and P. Dummett, *Life Pre-Intermediate Student's Book*, Hampshire, National Geographic Learning, 2019 (165)

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fog contains water. To get this water, some scientists are trying to collect the water in a big net. The net catches drops of water and it can collect between five and 30 liters of water per day.

Exercise answer key

1. The girl who was injured in the accident is now in hospital.
2. The waitress who served us was impolite and inpatient.
3. The building that was destroyed the fire has now been rebuilt.
4. The people that were arrested have now been released.
5. The bus that goes to the airport runs every half hour.
6. stories that have.

7 OK.

8. That sells newspapers.
9. That caused the accident.
10. OK.
11. A world that is changing.
12. OK.
13. The horse that won the race.
14. Colin told me about his new job, which he's enjoying very much.
15. My office, which is on the second floor, is very small.
16. OK.
17. Ben's father, who used to be a teacher, now works for a TV company.
18. OK.
19. The sun, which is one of millions of stars in the universe, provides us with heat and light.
20. Redwood trees are the tallest trees in the world.

21. Lake superior is the largest lake in the USA. 22. China built an amazing bridge… The bridge is the highest in the world.

23. Mercury is the closest planet to the sun.
24. Honeybees only live for 5 to 6 weeks.
25. Until around 4000 years ago, the Sahara desert was green….
26. In the small town called Rjukan in Norway, there is no sunlight for six months a year. People in Rjukan live without the sun from September to March. But this is changing thanks to Martin Anderson, a local man who had the clever idea to use a mirror to bring sunlight to the town. The mirror is on top of a mountain

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next to the town and it reflects light from the sun onto the town's main Square. The people love coming to the Square.

27. In primavera e in estate c'è spesso carenza d'acqua sulle montagne dell'Himalaya. Così, durante l'inverno, le persone costruiscono torri di ghiaccio. Mettono un'estremità di un lungo tubo in un fiume in alta montagna e poi portano l'altra estremità del tubo giù al villaggio. L'acqua esce dal tubo e si congela in una fontana per creare una torre di ghiaccio nel villaggio che dopo si scioglie e i contadini possono usarla sul loro terreno. Il deserto di Atacama, in Cile, è una delle zone più aride del mondo. Le piogge sono molto rare, ma c'è la nebbia, e la nebbia contiene acqua. Per recuperare quest'acqua, alcuni scienziati stanno cercando di raccoglierla in una grande rete. La rete cattura le gocce d'acqua e può raccogliere da cinque a 30 litri di acqua al giorno.

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